ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 6

SOCIAL SCIENCES

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE B

MARKS: 70 **TIME: 1½ hours**

An end-of-year test on Grade 6 Social Sciences. Geography: climate and vegetation around the world, and population growth and change. History: democracy and citizenship in South Africa, and medicine through time.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 6. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper has TWO sections: SECTION A (Geography) and SECTION B (History). Answer ALL the questions.
2. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
3. Read each question carefully before you answer.
4. Write neatly and in full sentences where you are asked to explain.

SECTION A: GEOGRAPHY

QUESTION 1: CLIMATE AND VEGETATION AROUND THE WORLD

1.1 Choose the correct answer. Write only the letter (A–D) next to the question number.

1.1.1 The Sahara is a … (1)

A rainforest. B desert. C tundra. D savanna.

1.1.2 The Amazon rainforest is in … (1)

A Africa. B South America. C Asia. D Europe.

1.1.3 Polar regions, where it is very cold all year, are found … (1)

A near the Equator. B near the North and South Poles.
C in the Karoo. D in all deserts.

1.1.4 The natural vegetation of the Western Cape, which has a Mediterranean climate, is called … (1)

A fynbos. B rainforest. C tundra. D bushveld.

1.2 FIGURE 1 is a climate graph for Town X, which is near the Equator. The bars show rainfall and the line shows temperature.

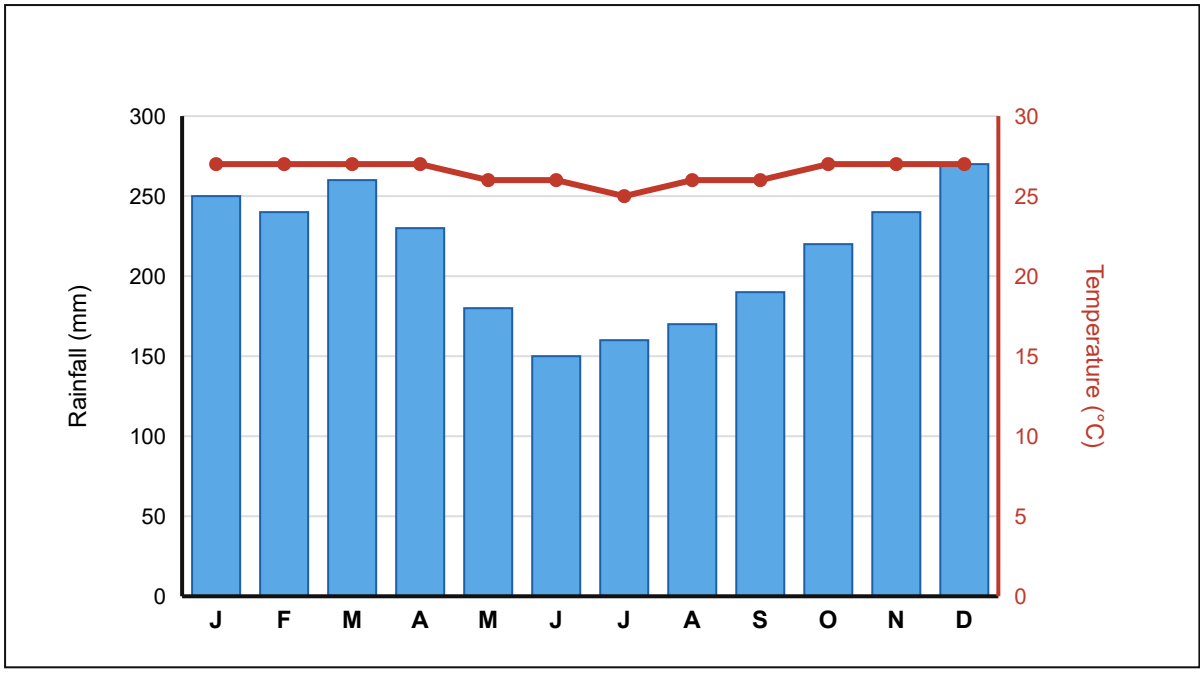


FIGURE 1: Climate graph of Town X

1.2.1 Which month gets the most rain? (1)

1.2.2 What is the temperature in Town X during most of the year? (1)

1.2.3 In which climate region is Town X? Give TWO reasons from the graph. (3)

1.2.4 What kind of natural vegetation grows around Town X? (1)

1.3 Give TWO ways in which people who live in very cold (polar) places are adapted to the climate. (2)

1.4 Give TWO ways in which animals survive in hot deserts. (2)

1.5 Name TWO crops that farmers grow in the grassland areas of South Africa. (2)

1.6 Give TWO reasons why very few people live in deserts. (2)

[18]

QUESTION 2: POPULATION GROWTH AND CHANGE

2.1 What does the word *population* mean? (1)

2.2 What is a census, and about how often does South Africa hold one? (2)

2.3 FIGURE 2 shows the population of South Africa in four censuses.

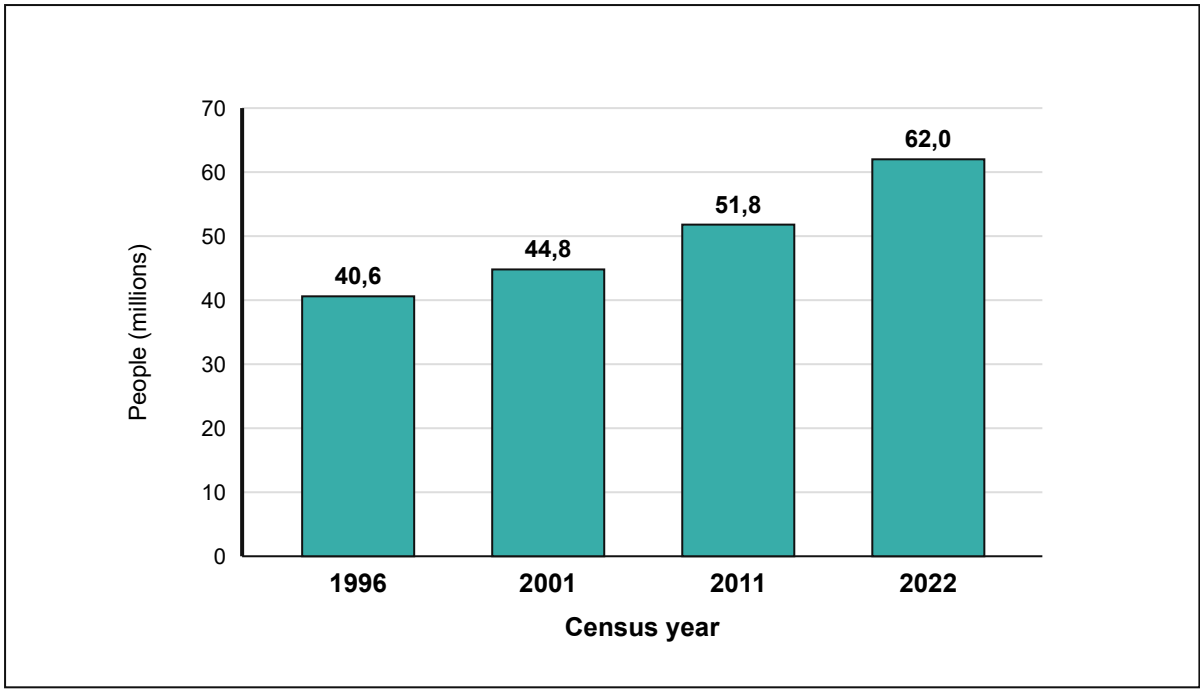


FIGURE 2: The population of South Africa

2.3.1 What was the population of South Africa in 2011? (1)

2.3.2 By how much did the population grow from 2011 to 2022? Show your working. (2)

2.3.3 Is the population of South Africa growing or getting smaller? (1)

2.4 Explain the difference between the *birth rate* and the *death rate*. (2)

2.5 Give TWO reasons why the population of a country grows. (2)

2.6 Many people move from rural areas to cities. This is called urbanisation.

2.6.1 Give TWO reasons why people move to cities. (2)

2.6.2 Give TWO problems that cities have when many people arrive quickly. (2)

2.7 Give TWO reasons why the death rate in a country can go down. (2)

[17]

TOTAL SECTION A: [35]

SECTION B: HISTORY

QUESTION 3: DEMOCRACY AND CITIZENSHIP

3.1 Choose a description from COLUMN B that matches each word in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–E) next to the question number. (5)

COLUMN A	COLUMN B
3.1.1 Parliament	A The paper on which a voter marks his or her choice
3.1.2 Constitution	B The place where the country's laws are made
3.1.3 Citizen	C A member of a country, who has rights and responsibilities
3.1.4 Ballot paper	D The highest law of the country

3.1.5 Election	E Choosing leaders by voting

3.2 Read SOURCE A and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE A: How to vote**
>
> Elections in South Africa are run by the Electoral Commission (IEC). To vote, you must be a South African citizen, be 18 years or older, have a South African ID and be registered on the voters' roll. Your vote is secret: nobody may see whom you voted for.

3.2.1 Give TWO things a person needs before he or she can vote. (2)

3.2.2 Why is it important that a vote is secret? (1)

3.2.3 Which organisation runs elections in South Africa? (1)

3.3 The government of South Africa has three arms (parts). Name them. (3)

3.4 What do we call the leader of a city or town council (municipality)? (1)

3.5 Give TWO ways in which learners can take part in democracy at school. (2)

3.6 Give TWO responsibilities of a good citizen. (2)

3.7 Children may not vote. Give ONE way in which children can still make their voices heard. (1)

[18]

QUESTION 4: MEDICINE THROUGH TIME

4.1 Read SOURCE B and answer the questions.

> **SOURCE B: Germs and clean hands**
>
> Long ago, many people believed that illness was caused by bad air or by evil spirits. In the 1860s, scientists showed that tiny germs cause many diseases. Doctors began to wash their hands and to clean their tools before operations. After this, many more patients survived.

4.1.1 Give TWO things that people long ago believed caused illness. (2)

4.1.2 What did scientists show in the 1860s? (1)

4.1.3 Name TWO things that doctors began to do before operations. (2)

4.1.4 Why did more patients survive after this? (1)

4.2 What are antibiotics used for? (1)

4.3 What do doctors use X-rays for? (1)

4.4 Give TWO ways in which hospitals today are different from hospitals long ago. (2)

4.5 "Prevention is better than cure." Give TWO ways to prevent illness. (2)

4.6 Why do many people in South Africa use both clinics and traditional healers? (2)

4.7 Name ONE disease that vaccines have helped to stop or control. (1)

4.8 What does a pharmacist do? (1)

4.9 Why must medicine be kept where small children cannot reach it? (1)

[17]

TOTAL SECTION B: [35]

TOTAL: 70

END OF QUESTION PAPER